

My Inside Voice — Kind or Unkind?

20–25 min · Week 4

OBJECTIVE	Students identify the difference between a Kind Coach and a Grumpy Gus inner voice, and practise replacing unkind self-talk.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · recognising self-talk; Self-Management: regulating internal narrative
VOCABULARY	inside voice · Kind Coach · Grumpy Gus · self-talk · kind · unkind
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet (with TWO voices ready) · Kind Coach / Grumpy Gus anchor chart paper · red and green markers

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Mistake Wall. "Last lesson: mistakes are normal. Today: when we make a mistake, what does our inside voice say?" Two student responses.

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have TWO voices that talk inside my head. One is kind. One is grumpy. Today we are going to meet them both."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 5

1

Meet Kind Coach

4 MIN

Sammy speaks in his Kind Coach voice (warm, gentle): "When I make a mistake, my Kind Coach says — 'Oops! What can I learn? Let's try again.' Kind Coach is honest AND kind. Kind Coach helps me grow.**"

2

Meet Grumpy Gus

4 MIN

Sammy switches to Grumpy Gus voice (sharper, theatrical, never frightening): "Grumpy Gus says — 'You ALWAYS mess up! You're BAD! You'll NEVER get it right!' Grumpy Gus attacks WHO YOU ARE — not just what happened. Grumpy Gus makes us want to hide.**"

3

Sort the Statements

8 MIN

Read 6–8 statements. Class sorts each into Kind Coach (green) or Grumpy Gus (red). Examples: "I made a mistake — I can fix it." (Kind) / "I always ruin everything." (Grumpy) / "What can I learn from this?" (Kind) / "Nobody likes me." (Grumpy). Add to anchor chart as you go.